

Attempting to batch- delete records in an unordered Sequential file

Click to view.

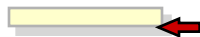
When viewing , left click (or press the Page Up key)
to see the next frame and right click (or press Page
Down) to see the previous frame.

Transaction File

RecordB
RecordM
RecordK

read

New Master File



RecordB
=
RecordM

?

Master File

RecordM
RecordH
RecordB
RecordN
RecordA
RecordK

read

We start by
reading a record
from each file.

Transaction File

RecordB
RecordM
RecordK



New Master File

RecordM



write

no



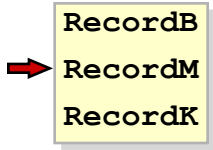
Master File

RecordM
RecordH
RecordB
RecordN
RecordA
RecordK



If the key fields in the records do not match, we don't need to delete this record, so we write it to the new file.

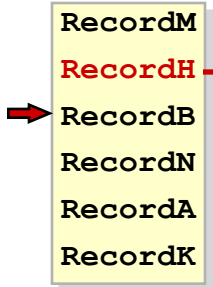
Transaction File



New Master File



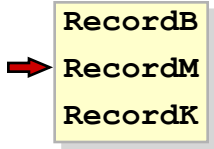
Master File



read

We have not yet found a match for the transaction file RecordB so we just need to get a record from the master file

Transaction File



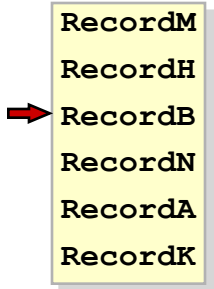
New Master File



write

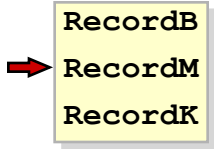
no

Master File

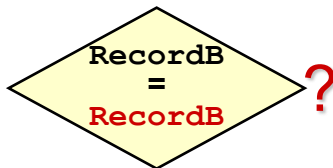
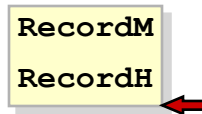


These don't match either so we write RecordH to the new file and then we get a new record from the master file

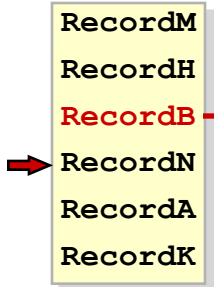
Transaction File



New Master File



Master File



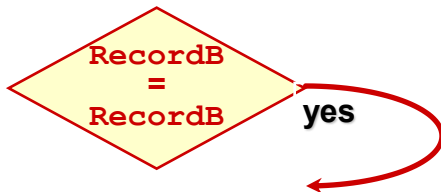
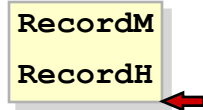
read



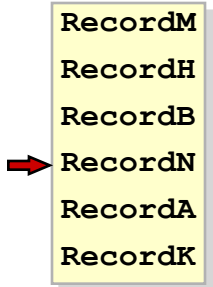
Transaction File



New Master File



Master File



We have a match!!

So we discard
RecordB (by ignoring
it) and get new records
from the transaction
and master files.

Transaction File

RecordB
RecordM
RecordK

read

New Master File

RecordM
RecordH

Master File

RecordM
RecordH
RecordB
RecordN
RecordA
RecordK

read

RecordM
=
RecordN

?

Once more the records don't match. So we need to write the master file record to the new master file, and get another record from the master file.

Transaction File

RecordB
RecordM
RecordK



New Master File

RecordM
RecordH
RecordN



write
no

Master File

RecordM
RecordH
RecordB
RecordN
RecordA
RecordK



This
When
field, v
write
matchin

A similar problem occurs with batch updates on an unordered file. When we write a record to the new master file we can't be sure that there is not an update for the record further down the transaction file.